

SUPERVISED VOCATIONAL QUALIFICATION DIPLOMA - EXAMINATION

Session: Revision Mock Set 08	Duration: 3 hours
Specialty: Psychotherapy	Coefficient: 04
Eliminatory mark: < 8/20	Training reference: VTI-AEDA examination style

COMPREHENSIVE VOCATIONAL PAPER PRACTICE SET 08

Revision material based on the supplied VTI-AEDA 2025 examination format and the supplied psychotherapy course recordings. Not an official examination paper.

PART ONE: PSYCHOPATHOLOGY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (10mks)

- During assessment, Grace reports excessive need to be cared for, difficulty making decisions independently, submissiveness and fear of separation. Which of the following is the BEST match?
 - Schizoid personality disorder
 - Dependent personality disorder
 - Stimulant intoxication
 - Borderline personality disorder
- Amina, a 45-year-old accountant, presents with persistent social-communication difficulties together with restricted or repetitive patterns of behavior or interests beginning in development. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - Borderline personality disorder
 - Major depressive disorder
 - Bipolar disorder
 - Autism spectrum disorder
- Grace, a 29-year-old laboratory technician, presents with recurrent unexpected panic attacks followed by persistent worry about more attacks or maladaptive avoidance. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - Schizoid personality disorder
 - Specific phobia
 - Panic disorder
 - Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
- A therapist notes that Amina has excessive, difficult-to-control worry across several life areas for about six months, with tension, restlessness or poor sleep. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?
 - Major depressive disorder
 - Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
 - Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
 - Panic disorder
- Victor, a 52-year-old laboratory technician, presents with marked fear of a specific object or situation that triggers immediate anxiety and avoidance out of proportion to the actual danger. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?
 - Specific phobia
 - Generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)
 - Social anxiety disorder
 - Borderline personality disorder
- Victor, a 32-year-old sales representative, presents with marked fear of social or performance situations because of possible scrutiny, embarrassment or negative evaluation. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Major depressive disorder
- B. Social anxiety disorder
- C. Opioid intoxication
- D. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)

7. A therapist notes that Zachary has fear and avoidance of situations where escape may be difficult or help unavailable, such as crowds, public transport or being outside alone. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?

- A. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
- B. Agoraphobia
- C. Bulimia nervosa
- D. Social anxiety disorder

8. Uma, a 27-year-old laboratory technician, presents with intrusive unwanted thoughts or urges and/or repetitive behaviors or mental acts performed to reduce anxiety. Which diagnosis or clinical concept best fits this presentation?

- A. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
- B. Agoraphobia
- C. Obsessive-compulsive disorder (OCD)
- D. Brief psychotic disorder

9. During assessment, Esther reports after trauma, recurrent intrusions or nightmares, avoidance, negative changes in mood/cognition and heightened arousal persisting beyond one month. Which of the following is the BEST match?

- A. Post-traumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
- B. Borderline personality disorder
- C. Anorexia nervosa, restricting type
- D. Substance use disorder

10. A therapist notes that Nadine has at least two weeks of depressed mood and/or loss of interest with associated sleep, appetite, energy, concentration, guilt, psychomotor or suicidal symptoms. Which condition should be considered first from the options below?

- A. Major depressive disorder
- B. Schizoid personality disorder
- C. Schizophrenia
- D. Stimulant intoxication

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. PTSD is diagnosed solely because a frightening event occurred. TRUE / FALSE
2. Dependent personality disorder may involve difficulty making everyday decisions without reassurance. TRUE / FALSE
3. An opioid is more likely than a stimulant to produce drowsiness and physiologic slowing. TRUE / FALSE
4. A manic episode is simply a happy mood with no change in energy or functioning. TRUE / FALSE
5. Anorexia nervosa can include binge-eating/purging behavior if the person also meets the low-weight anorexia criteria. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. Differentiate anorexia nervosa from bulimia nervosa. (2mks)
2. State two characteristic features of a manic episode. (2mks)
3. What is comorbidity? (2mks)
4. Name the four broad PTSD symptom clusters taught in modern formulations. (2mks)
5. What is meant by anhedonia? (2mks)

PART TWO: THEORIES/TECHNIQUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. In a session with Amina, the counselor emphasizes behavior is shaped by its consequences, including reinforcement and punishment. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Flooding
- B. Psychoanalytic therapy
- C. Exposure therapy
- D. Operant conditioning

2. In a session with Nadine, the counselor emphasizes a behavior increases because it removes or prevents an aversive stimulus. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Negative reinforcement
- B. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
- C. Resistance
- D. Existential therapy

3. A therapist working with Yvette uses an intervention characterized by a previously reinforced behavior decreases when the reinforcement maintaining it is consistently withheld. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Extinction
- B. Existential therapy
- C. Classical conditioning
- D. Empty-chair technique

4. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: learning behavior by observing what happens to another person or by imitating a model?

- A. Cognitive restructuring
- B. Countertransference
- C. Social modeling
- D. Gestalt dream work

5. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: planned contact with feared stimuli, memories or situations while reducing avoidance so fear can be relearned?

- A. Rational emotive imagery
- B. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)
- C. Exposure therapy
- D. Resistance

6. In a session with Brenda, the counselor emphasizes direct, real-life exposure to a feared object or situation. This BEST illustrates:

- A. In vivo exposure
- B. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
- C. Social skills training
- D. Retroflexion

7. A therapist working with Hassan uses an intervention characterized by gradual exposure to a fear hierarchy combined with relaxation or another incompatible response. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
- B. Exposure therapy
- C. Systematic desensitization
- D. Adlerian therapy

8. A therapist working with Tina uses an intervention characterized by rapid and prolonged exposure to a high-intensity feared stimulus or situation without gradual hierarchy progression. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Free association
- B. Negative reinforcement
- C. Psychoanalytic therapy
- D. Flooding

9. A therapist working with Daniel uses an intervention characterized by systematically tensing and releasing muscle groups to learn physical relaxation and reduce arousal. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Social modeling
- B. Progressive muscle relaxation
- C. Gestalt therapy
- D. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)

10. A therapist working with Irene uses an intervention characterized by a skills-based therapy especially associated with emotion dysregulation and borderline personality disorder, using mindfulness, distress tolerance, emotion regulation and interpersonal effectiveness. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
- B. Adlerian therapy
- C. Free association
- D. Retroflexion

11. Which psychotherapy concept is most accurately described by the following: behavioral teaching and rehearsal of interpersonal skills such as greetings, eye contact, listening and conversation?

- A. Cognitive restructuring
- B. Social skills training
- C. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)
- D. Rational Emotive Behavior Therapy (REBT)

12. In a session with Samuel, the counselor emphasizes the client says whatever thoughts, feelings, images or memories come to mind without censoring them. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Systematic desensitization
- B. Free association
- C. Existential therapy
- D. Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT)

13. In a session with Kemi, the counselor emphasizes the therapist explains or offers meaning about patterns, defenses, dreams, resistance or behavior. This BEST illustrates:

- A. Interpretation
- B. Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT)
- C. Adlerian therapy
- D. Cognitive restructuring

14. A therapist working with Patricia uses an intervention characterized by the client unconsciously avoids material or processes that threaten to bring unacceptable conflict into awareness. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Resistance
- B. In vivo exposure
- C. Transference
- D. Progressive muscle relaxation

15. A therapist working with Fidel uses an intervention characterized by the client redirects feelings, expectations or relationship patterns from important past relationships onto the therapist. Which approach or technique is being used?

- A. Transference
- B. Flooding
- C. Existential therapy

D. Gestalt therapy

SECTION B: ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE (5mks)

1. Progressive muscle relaxation involves systematically increasing tension and never releasing it. TRUE / FALSE
2. In vivo exposure occurs only in imagination. TRUE / FALSE
3. Retroflexion involves directing toward oneself an impulse that might otherwise be directed outward. TRUE / FALSE
4. Rational emotive imagery belongs to the REBT family of techniques. TRUE / FALSE
5. Social skills training can use modeling, role play, rehearsal and feedback. TRUE / FALSE

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. What is transference? (2mks)
2. What is countertransference? (2mks)
3. State one goal of existential therapy. (1mks)

PART THREE: PROFESSIONAL ORIENTATION AND ETHICAL/LEGAL ISSUES IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. During supervision, Fidel describes keeping commitments, maintaining trust and being faithful to professional responsibilities. Which concept should guide the discussion?
 - A. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - B. Privacy
 - C. Fidelity
 - D. Veracity
2. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by an ongoing process in which the client receives understandable information about services, risks, benefits, alternatives, limits of confidentiality and choice. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Termination and referral
 - B. Subpoena response
 - C. Informed consent
 - D. Sexual relationship with a current client
3. In professional practice, a situation calls for the professional duty to protect information learned in the therapeutic relationship, subject to recognized legal and ethical exceptions. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Confidentiality
 - B. Justice
 - C. Duty to warn/protect
 - D. Dual or multiple relationship
4. In professional practice, a situation calls for the client's broader right to control access to self, body and personal information. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Technology ethics
 - B. Termination and referral
 - C. Privacy
 - D. Informed consent
5. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by a legal protection that may prevent compelled disclosure of certain therapy communications in judicial proceedings, depending on jurisdiction. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Informed consent
 - B. Sexual relationship with a current client
 - C. Privileged communication
 - D. Nonmaleficence
6. A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by taking reasonable protective action when a client presents a serious, credible threat toward an identifiable person, as required by applicable law and ethics. The BEST answer is:
 - A. Duty to warn/protect
 - B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - C. Fidelity
 - D. Dual or multiple relationship
7. In professional practice, a situation calls for reporting suspected abuse or other legally reportable situations to designated authorities when law or professional duty requires it. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
 - A. Mandated reporting
 - B. Autonomy
 - C. Bartering
 - D. Confidentiality

- 8.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by professional negligence in which a duty is breached and the breach causes harm. The BEST answer is:
- A. Justice
 - B. Veracity
 - C. Nonmaleficence
 - D. Malpractice
- 9.** In professional practice, a situation calls for practicing only within areas supported by appropriate education, training, supervised experience and current skill. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Justice
 - B. Termination and referral
 - C. Professional competence
 - D. Boundary violation
- 10.** In professional practice, a situation calls for a situation in which the therapist has another significant role or relationship with the client in addition to therapy. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Dual or multiple relationship
 - B. Bartering
 - C. Mandated reporting
 - D. Professional competence
- 11.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by a departure from customary therapeutic boundaries that may be clinically appropriate and non-exploitative in context. The BEST answer is:
- A. Dual or multiple relationship
 - B. Record keeping
 - C. Boundary crossing
 - D. Subpoena response
- 12.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by a serious harmful or exploitative breach of therapeutic boundaries. The BEST answer is:
- A. Record keeping
 - B. Sexual relationship with a current client
 - C. Bartering
 - D. Boundary violation
- 13.** A counselor asks which principle or professional concept is defined by sexual or romantic involvement with a current therapy client. The BEST answer is:
- A. Sexual relationship with a current client
 - B. Duty to warn/protect
 - C. Confidentiality
 - D. Dual or multiple relationship
- 14.** In professional practice, a situation calls for considering clinical meaning, value, timing, culture, power and exploitation risk before accepting or declining a client gift. Which ethical/legal concept is MOST directly involved?
- A. Privacy
 - B. Ethical response to colleague misconduct
 - C. Subpoena response
 - D. Gift decision-making
- 15.** During supervision, Lucas describes accepting goods or services instead of money when ethically permissible, not exploitative and not clinically contraindicated. Which concept should guide the discussion?
- A. Bartering
 - B. Technology ethics

C. Boundary crossing

D. Beneficence

SECTION B: ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS CORRECTLY (5mks)

1. Differentiate privacy from confidentiality. **(2mks)**
2. Differentiate confidentiality from privileged communication. **(1mks)**
3. Define malpractice. **(1mks)**
4. Give two elements of informed consent. **(1mks)**

SECTION C: SHORT ESSAY (5mks)

1. When is termination ethically appropriate? **(2mks)**
2. State one key ethical requirement for clinical records. **(2mks)**
3. Why are dual relationships ethically risky? **(1mks)**

PART FOUR: CULTURAL DIVERSITY / GROUP THERAPY / COUNSELING PROCESS / TREATMENT PLAN IN PSYCHOTHERAPY

Section A: Multiple Choice Questions: Place a bold tick against the appropriate response option provided. (15mks)

1. In counseling practice, Tina encounters a situation involving implementing agreed therapeutic strategies and monitoring the client's response. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Intervention stage
 - B. Skills-development group
 - C. Performing stage
 - D. Open-ended questioning
2. A trainee observes reviewing progress, consolidating coping skills, planning relapse prevention or referral and ending the professional relationship responsibly. This is an example of:
 - A. Cognitive-behavioral group
 - B. Termination and follow-up
 - C. Intervention stage
 - D. Progress review
3. A trainee observes attending closely to verbal and nonverbal communication and showing the client that the message has been heard and understood. This is an example of:
 - A. Paraphrasing
 - B. Therapeutic confrontation
 - C. Cultural competence
 - D. Active listening
4. A trainee observes identifying and feeding back the emotional meaning expressed by the client. This is an example of:
 - A. Reflection of feeling
 - B. Termination and follow-up
 - C. Progress review
 - D. Group confidentiality
5. In counseling practice, Daniel encounters a situation involving restating the essence of the client's content in fresh words without changing its meaning. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Progress review
 - B. Self-disclosure
 - C. Paraphrasing
 - D. Group confidentiality
6. In counseling practice, Yvette encounters a situation involving questions that invite elaboration rather than a yes/no answer. Which concept BEST applies?
 - A. Reflection of feeling
 - B. Cultural competence
 - C. Paraphrasing
 - D. Open-ended questioning
7. A trainee observes respectfully pointing out discrepancies between a client's words, behaviors, values or nonverbal cues. This is an example of:
 - A. Termination and follow-up
 - B. Ethnocentrism
 - C. Therapeutic confrontation
 - D. Paraphrasing

8. In counseling practice, Grace encounters a situation involving the therapist deliberately shares limited personal information when it is likely to benefit the client rather than meet the therapist's own needs. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Self-disclosure
- B. Adjourning stage
- C. Open-ended questioning
- D. Norming stage

9. In counseling practice, Wendy encounters a situation involving a collaborative written or explicit plan linking identified problems to goals, measurable objectives, interventions and review. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Group role
- B. Forming stage
- C. Treatment plan
- D. Assessment

10. In counseling practice, Samuel encounters a situation involving an organized explanation linking the client's presenting problems with relevant history, triggers, maintaining factors, strengths and a rationale for intervention. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Case formulation
- B. Intervention stage
- C. Assessment
- D. Active listening

11. A trainee observes evaluating whether objectives are being achieved and modifying the treatment plan when progress is absent, circumstances change or goals are met. This is an example of:

- A. Intervention stage
- B. Cognitive-behavioral group
- C. Forming stage
- D. Progress review

12. In counseling practice, Quentin encounters a situation involving ongoing development of awareness, cultural knowledge, clinical skills and meaningful encounters with diverse clients. Which concept BEST applies?

- A. Professional interpreter use
- B. Cultural competence
- C. Skills-development group
- D. Assessment

13. A trainee observes judging other cultures primarily by the standards of one's own culture and treating one's own as the norm. This is an example of:

- A. Intervention stage
- B. Skills-development group
- C. Ethnocentrism
- D. Reflection of feeling

14. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: pressuring a client to adopt the therapist's or dominant culture's beliefs, values or practices?

- A. Rapport building
- B. Support group
- C. Cultural imposition
- D. Therapeutic confrontation

15. Which counseling/group/cultural concept is BEST described by: using a qualified interpreter rather than relying on a child or untrained friend when language barriers affect care?

- A. Storming stage
- B. Skills-development group

C. Professional interpreter use

D. Progress review

SECTION B: SHORT ESSAY (10mks)

1. What is case formulation? **(4mks)**
2. Describe the storming and norming stages of group development. **(4mks)**
3. Give four examples of counseling skills used in an intake session. **(2mks)**

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SIMULATION OF REAL WORKING SITUATION PAPER PRACTICE SET 08

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SECTION I

1. Driving phobia

Yannick, 35, stopped driving after a serious road accident many years ago. As a passenger she develops sweating, shaking, light-headedness and an urge to escape, except when a trusted relative drives and talks calmly. A new job now requires independent travel and Yannick wants to regain driving confidence.

What therapeutic approach/technique would you use? Explain in detail how you would apply it from assessment to graded practice. (25mks)

2. Depression after loss

For the past three weeks, Zita, 42, has felt sad nearly every day after losing a job. he reports loss of interest, fatigue, poor concentration, reduced appetite, insomnia and thoughts such as "I am useless and nothing will improve."

Identify the likely disorder and demonstrate a CBT-oriented session, including assessment, safety and techniques. (25mks)

SECTION II

1. Bereavement and person-centered counseling

Alice, 49, recently lost a spouse and arrives tearful, disheveled and unsure whether the intensity of grief is "normal." she says family members keep telling her to "move on," which has made her stop talking about the loss.

Demonstrate how a person-centered therapist would conduct the session. Include the core conditions and appropriate assessment. (25mks)

2. Generalized anxiety and worry

Bruno, 56, worries most days about finances, health, family and work. The worry has persisted for many months, is difficult to stop, and is accompanied by muscle tension, restlessness and poor sleep. he repeatedly seeks reassurance but remains anxious.

Give the most likely diagnosis and show how CBT and relaxation/coping methods could be used. (25mks)